

MOVIE

Mank

★★★★☆ | Netflix's *Mank* chronicles the life of renowned Hollywood screenwriter, Herman J Mankiewicz and his struggles with alcoholism, as he races to finish the screenplay for the 1941 award-winning film, *Citizen Kane*. The first thing you notice about this film is the presentation and the way it screams "Classic Filmmaking". The cinematography is fully monochromatic and would be the first time we've seen Fincher stray from his signature yellow-blue colour palette. Despite maintaining the modern, widescreen aspect ratio, the film feels vintage, owing to the blur and graininess in visuals. The attention to detail and historical accuracy is quite impressive, as seen with the set designs, usage of greenscreens for driving sequences,



and the fade to black transitions. Not to mention, the sound design is muffled, and at times echo-ish which totally resonates with older films.

Coming to the story, well... it's a biography about film history that

eventually branches into politics. Mainly centred around the Great Depression, and its effects on the movie business, the economy, etc. So, it might not necessarily appeal to mainstream audiences. That is not to say it's boring, as the film still manages to keep you captivated through every subplot. Sure, there are a few low points where some of the dialogues just seem to keep dragging for no reason. But the script often tends to get witty and interesting in bursts, giving you just enough reason to stick around. Furthermore, the performance from the cast is outstanding. Gary Oldman as Mank, delivers an excellent act of a bedridden, depressed writer, while needlessly mumbling like the old drunk he is. Amanda Seyfried, on the other hand, gracefully spews a spitting image of the young and blonde, Marion Davies. Same could be said for Lily Collins and Charles Dance, who amongst the rest of the actors, ideally glimmered in the limelight.

TV SHOW

The Mandalorian (Season 2)

★★★★☆ | The show has been following a rather simple structure up until now. Mando is trying to get Baby Yoda a.k.a. 'The kid' back to the Jedi and each episode has him landing upon a new planet in search of someone who can guide him towards the nearest Jedi considering that the keepers of the peace are no longer easy to find since there are barely anyone left alive after Order 66. On whichever planet he lands up on, Mando meets the certain someone, is promised information but on the condition that he helps with a little rescue or sabotage operation. Operation proceeds fine, and off he goes to the next planet. Rinse and repeat!



Season 2 finally puts an end to the monotony by pulling the biggest, and most commonly used, contrived plot device ever – the Deus Ex Machina. And look what the cat dragged in! We're not going to name names but a Jedi grandmaster shows up to save the day. The whole concept of these

numerous Star Wars projects was to hero the ancillary characters and make use of the enormous collection of novels and short stories that make up the Star Wars Canon. Introducing such a principal character takes away from that. Is this really the way?

First we had Bo-Katan, then Ahsoka, followed by Boba Fett and now, a Jedi Grandmaster? It seems, we're starting to see what The Mandalorian is all about. After having established itself as a wonderful series, it is now paving the way as the platform wherein all of the upcoming Star Wars projects can be introduced. Ergo, this is where the video canon grows to match the expansive written canon. All the while, detracting from what The Mandalorian could really be. Unless Disney stops using each episode to introduce yet another Star Wars project, The Mandalorian could end up being a mess of contrived storylines. The series has been good thus far, but the overreach in the season finale was a little too much. Let's hope The Mandalorian gets back on track sooner than later.